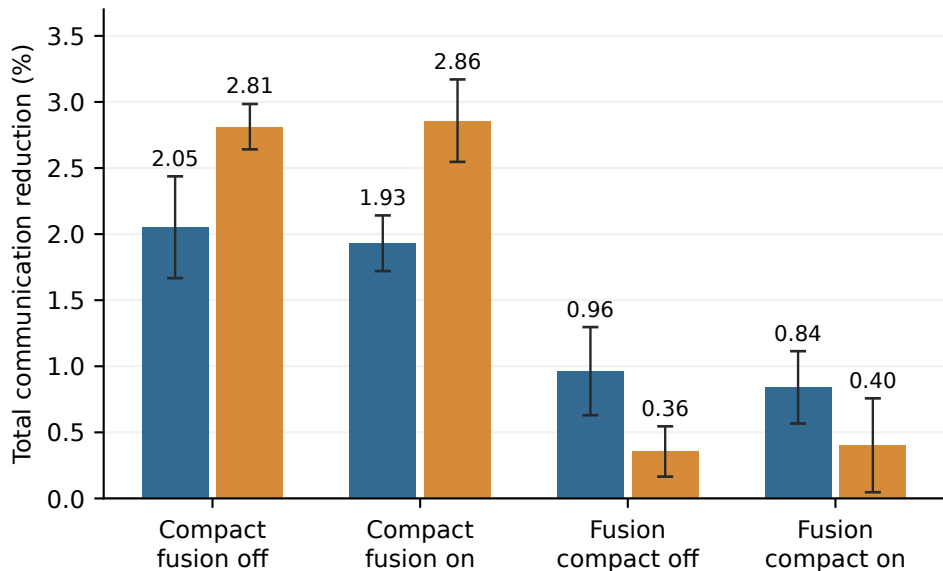


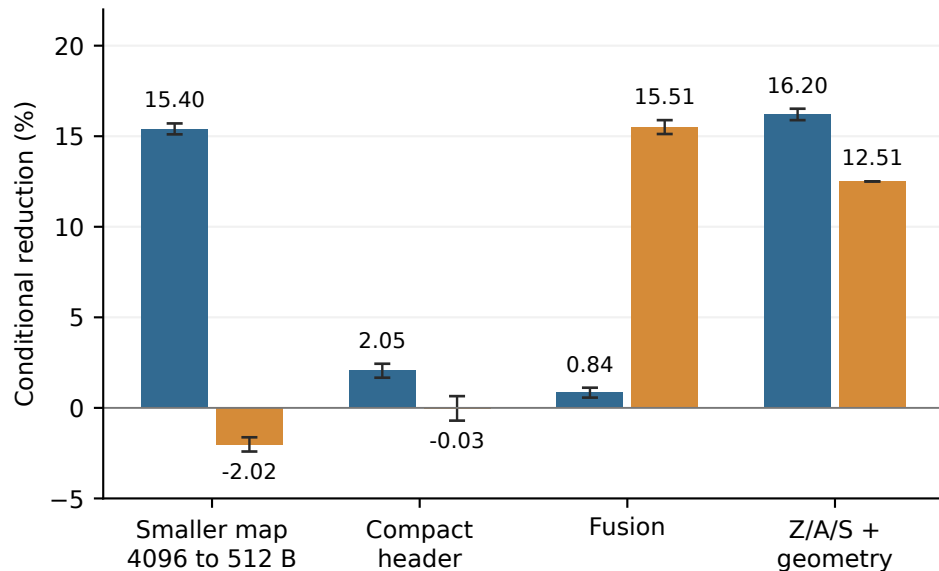
Z4 / A3 / S3    Z7 / A6 / S6

(a) Separate header and fusion effects



Bytes    RPCs

(b) Incremental steps in the chosen order



R0 ablation | N = 16,384; data blocks = 4,096 B; uniform workload; five paired runs per cell.

2,048 warmup + 4,096 measured requests; bars show mean and 95% t intervals.

All protocol bytes included. Steps are conditional and not additive; parameter retuning also changes tree geometry.